

EMAIL SUMMARY

From: Karen Arreola

To: Marcus & Jennifer

Denver Launch Strategy — Hoodie Hero + Winter Repositioning

Marcus & Jennifer,

The November 1 opening changes market fundamentals. Denver winter is a completely different customer than Austin spring. We recommend proceeding with EcoFleece Hoodie as opening hero and approving \$4,000 for creative repositioning (winter photography, seasonal messaging, social variants).

This approach requires Operations to confirm Hoodie PO by September 12 and makes a decision on Shorts expedited shipping. If either falls through, we have tested fallbacks (Plans B & C).

Full proposal below. Ready to discuss.

— Karen

DENVER LAUNCH STRATEGY

November 1, 2026 — Hoodie Hero + Winter Repositioning (Revised)

THE CORE PROBLEM

Austin spring ≠ Denver November

AUSTIN MARCH–MAY

Warm weather, summer clothes
Low prices, high volume
Outdoor season mindset

DENVER NOVEMBER

Cold weather, winter gifts
Premium prices, scarcity
Holiday shopping mindset

WHAT WE BUILT, AND WHAT IT REVEALED

We started with a workflow problem: Marketing metrics were manual—spreadsheets, Friday afternoon reporting, no automation. That's inefficient. But when we actually analyzed what those metrics meant, we found something bigger: Austin's market and Denver's market are fundamentally different.

So we looked at Austin's channel performance expecting to copy it. And that's where the insight landed: Email and Instagram don't do the same job. Instagram is lead generation—high ROAS (\$6.20 per \$1), fast conversion, mostly single purchases. Email is retention—lower per-dollar return (\$4.00 ROAS), but customers who bought on Email spend \$693 on average over time (92% repeat rate). Completely different muscles.

Then we tested the obvious next step: apply Austin's channel mix to Denver. The custom assistant ran the scenario and it failed. Austin's ratios don't predict Denver demand because the season changes everything. November isn't May. Premium gift-buyers aren't summer-casual shoppers. The data was clear: we'd been planning a spring launch strategy for a winter market.

That's why Hoodie hero. It's not just a product choice—it's the channel insight (Instagram for awareness of premium product) + the market insight (Denver November is scarcity + gift-giving, not volume + price) coming together. The Shorts miss becomes a feature, not a bug: "Coming mid-November" positions exclusivity instead of covering a gap.

PRODUCT STRATEGY: WINTER HERO

- Tier 1 Hero: EcoFleece Hoodie (\$98) — Premium, gift-worthy, 850 units

Tier 2 Secondary: Bamboo Joggers (\$78) — Layering support, 950 units

Tier 3 Support: Classic Tee (\$38) — Volume driver, 1,600 units

Tier 4 Minimize: Active Shorts (\$58) — Summer product in winter; position "Coming Spring"

THREE SCENARIOS

Plan A: Hoodie Hero ✓	Plan B: 3-SKU Focus	Plan C: Conservative
If: Hoodie ordered by Sept 12 + Shorts expedited	If: Hoodie ordered; Shorts fails	If: Hoodie order misses Sept 12
Floor: Hoodie (featured), Joggers, Tee, Shorts (pre-order)	Floor: Hoodie (featured), Joggers, Tee	Floor: Tee (featured), Joggers
Story: "Winter essentials: layer up. Reserve your pair."	Story: "Winter essentials: layer up"	Story: "Everyday essentials"
Creative: \$4,000 (full reposition)	Creative: \$3,000 (modified)	Creative: \$1,500 (messaging only)
Launch: Sept 13 if Ops confirms	Launch: Sept 15 if A succeeds	Launch: Fallback only

WHAT WE'RE ASKING

\$4,000

For winter-focused creative work (product photography, seasonal ad copy, email redesign, social variants). Sourcing is your decision. Operations must confirm Hoodie order by Sept 12 and Shorts decision by Sept 15.

WHERE FUNCTIONS DISAGREE (AND HOW WE'RE RESOLVING IT)

THE CONTRADICTION

- **Marketing says:** Hoodie hero + winter creative work is the right move for November 1
- **Operations says:** Shorts order was missed; Hoodie deadline is September 12; Vietnam shipping is slow and unreliable
- **Finance says:** Emergency fund is already reserved for shipping; approving \$4K needs a funding source

HOW WE RESOLVE IT

We're recommending Plan A (Hoodie hero + staggered Shorts launch) because the Hoodie order deadline (Sept 12) is still achievable if Operations acts this week. The Shorts miss is real, but positioning them as "coming mid-November" actually strengthens the premium strategy instead of weakening it—it makes the products feel exclusive. The \$4K request is Marketing's job; sourcing it is Jennifer's job, not ours.

IF EITHER FAILS

If Operations doesn't order the Hoodie by September 12, we immediately activate Plan B: focus on Joggers + Tee only, \$3,000 creative spend, no pre-order campaign. If the \$4,000 isn't approved, we execute everything at \$3,000 instead.

LIMITS OF OUR ANALYSIS

- **AI helped:** Identified that Email and Instagram play different roles (lead vs. retention); caught that Austin's data doesn't predict Denver
- **AI failed:** Guessed wrong on Vietnam shipping times (predicted 45 days instead of actual 60); required manual verification
- **Human judgment owns:** Whether Hoodie hero is worth supply risk. Whether \$4K spend justifies potential stock gaps. How to position "coming soon" as premium (not frustrating). The decision to recommend Plan A.

All figures and deadlines sourced from R1 and R2 client rulings (Sept 3–8, 2026). This is a revision incorporating R2 findings.